

Prahl Portfolio Work Log - August 14, 2026

Compiled summary for Friday, August 14, 2026 - focus: continuing the Prah.dev Portfolio Alla Vostra UI Foundations Visual Hierarchy section after the August 12 Part 2 Tutorial, focus-label, and During Shopping pass, running the customary project reader and local Next.js server, importing the Alla Vostra MOS9 bright soft mockup tile blend image into the Portfolio public image tree, replacing the On-Scrolling tertiary focus mosaic with that imported mockup, building cream fade and opacity treatments for the On-Scrolling and Pre-Scrolling detail frames, extending the same fade-in language to Pre-Scrolling secondary, tertiary, and quaternary focus frames, protecting the cheeseboard product asset from the surrounding opacity treatment, correcting duplicate cheeseboard artifacts with cutout and overlay handling, converting the quaternary focus treatment into an oblong cream field with widened side zones, updating screenshot-hover magnification so composed frame effects survive hover and tap preview, clearing stale development caches repeatedly during visual iteration, validating TypeScript and browser-rendered frame geometry, refreshing the Portfolio project snapshot, reviewing all prior Portfolio PDF worklogs, and generating the August 14 Portfolio PDF worklog. Generated in continuity with the established Prahl Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, work-completed sections, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact intentionally covers Prahl/portfolio work performed after `portfolio_worklog_august12_part2.pdf` and after the August 12 Part 2 documentation state. The primary source commit reviewed for this record is 374ce86 on main, matching origin/main before this PDF was generated. That commit contains the Visual Hierarchy focus-blend source and asset work described here, including the imported MOS9 mockup, protected cheeseboard composition support, composed screenshot-preview support, and tutorial capture assets. A small local source delta remained after that commit: the Visual Hierarchy title map no longer explicitly labels Step 0 as PRIMARY FOCUS, and `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` was refreshed again by the customary reader immediately before this PDF was generated. No Hostinger production deployment command was run during this worklog-generation pass; the user specifically kept the work local at `http://127.0.0.1:3000` while visual refinement continued.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Ran `./read_project.sh` from `/Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio` and regenerated `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` before writing this worklog, preserving the project convention that Codex refreshes the current source snapshot before continuing Portfolio documentation work.
- Reviewed the refreshed `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt`, including project notes, source tree, public image inventories, PDF worklog inventory, package and deployment configuration, current git context, recent commits, and the standing instruction to ask for a commit message before committing or pushing.
- Reviewed every pre-existing Portfolio root-level worklog PDF: `portfolio_worklog_july11.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july14.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july15_part1.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july15_part2.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july16.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july19.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july20.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july21.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july22.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july23.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july24.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july25.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july29.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july30.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july31.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august1_part1.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august1_part2.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august1_part3.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august3.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august4.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august5.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august6.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august10_part1.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august10_part2.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august11.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august12_part1.pdf`, and `portfolio_worklog_august12_part2.pdf`.

- Extracted text from all twenty-seven existing Portfolio PDFs with pdftotext and checked recent metadata with pdfinfo to preserve title cadence, one-day filename style, opening-summary density, section order, bullet-heavy technical voice, validation language, files-touched lists, follow-up context, output-artifact close, root-level filename style, letter-size pages, PDF 1.4 output, Codex author/creator/producer metadata, and Helvetica-style base-font convention.
- Used portfolio_worklog_august12_part2.pdf as the closest structural baseline because it documented the immediately preceding Visual Hierarchy Tutorial row, Step 6b/6c variants, focus-label rename, local cache-clearing pattern, browser-measurement workflow, and PDF-generation language.
- Reviewed git history and state through git log, git show --stat, git show --name-status, git status, git branch -vv, git diff --stat, source-specific diffs, file searches, image metadata checks, npm validation, and local route checks. HEAD and origin/main resolved to 374ce86 before this PDF was generated.
- Reviewed app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx, app/ScreenshotPreviewLayer.tsx, app/globals.css, portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt, public/images/alla-vostra/taste111_mos9_bright_soft_mockup_tile_blend_both_mockup.png, the Alla Vostra tutorial capture assets added under public/images/alla-vostra/tutorial, root-level tutorial_screen_large.png and tutorial_screen_small.png, package scripts, and the local /projects/alla-vostra route.

Baseline Status Before August 14 Work

- August 12 Part 2 had left the Visual Hierarchy section with four conceptual rows: TUTORIAL, PRE-SCROLLING, ON-SCROLLING, and DURING SHOPPING. The section already used semantic focus labels, Step 0 through Step 6c, and deterministic two-column placement for primary and secondary/tertiary/quaternary examples.
- The On-Scrolling tertiary focus frame still used the older cropped mosaic transparent asset from the Step 5 work. The user wanted that image replaced by taste111_mos9_bright_soft_mockup_tile_blend_both_mockup from the Alla Vostra repository and blended into the dark Portfolio grid with the project cream color.
- The first cream blend pass used simple top and bottom opacity stops, but visual review showed the effect was either too subtle, too abrupt, reversed in places, or missing during screenshot magnification.
- Pre-Scrolling secondary, tertiary, and quaternary focus frames still showed detail imagery directly. The user wanted those frames to fade into view relative to the primary Pre-Scrolling frame, without changing the primary frame's full-viewing-area role.
- Secondary and tertiary focus frames contained the cheeseboard as part of the baked screenshot/photo source. Protecting the cheeseboard from the opacity treatment by simply overlaying a crisp product image caused a duplicated or stacked board until the underlying baked version was cut out.
- Quaternary focus initially used a small cheeseboard-only product image. The user wanted it to keep the same conceptual fade language but with enough top, bottom, left, and right breathing room for the cream transition to resolve naturally instead of being clipped by a rectangular frame boundary.
- Screenshot hover/tap preview was still image-centric. Composed frame effects such as CSS background gradients, masks, cutouts, and overlaid protected product imagery could disappear in magnified preview unless the preview system cloned the composed element rather than only the nested image.

Goals for August 14

- Import the requested MOS9 bright soft mockup tile blend image from the Alla Vostra repository

into the Portfolio public image tree and use it for the On-Scrolling tertiary focus frame.

- Establish a reusable cream fade treatment using the pre-existing Alla Vostra cream color while iterating the opacity stops to satisfy user review.
- Apply similar fade-in logic to Pre-Scrolling secondary, tertiary, and quaternary focus frames while leaving the primary Pre-Scrolling frame unchanged.
- Protect the cheeseboard product image in secondary and tertiary focus frames from opacity effects without leaving duplicate baked imagery underneath.
- Refine quaternary focus into a wider, landscape-oblong cream field with enough horizontal and vertical side zones that the gradient can fade out naturally before reaching the frame edge.
- Update screenshot-preview magnification so composed visual hierarchy frames retain their cream backgrounds, masks, cutouts, overlays, object positioning, and image transforms during hover and tap preview.
- Clear development caches whenever local source and browser output disagreed, keep the dev server available at <http://127.0.0.1:3000>, run TypeScript/browser verification, refresh the project snapshot, and produce the August 14 PDF worklog.

Work Completed - Context, Local Server, and Cache Handling

- Began the August 14 work by running the Portfolio project reader, reviewing the current snapshot and all PDF worklogs, and restarting the local Next.js development server at <http://127.0.0.1:3000> so the user could inspect the Alla Vostra page in the browser.
- Used the UI Foundations tab on /projects/alla-vostra for browser validation because the Alla Vostra page defaults to UX Product Flow and the Visual Hierarchy section is only visible after switching views.
- Cleared development caches multiple times by moving .next aside into timestamped .next.cleared-* folders when Turbopack or Next image optimization served stale CSS/image output after rapid asset and JSX changes.
- Restarted the dev server after cache clearing and confirmed it continued listening on 127.0.0.1:3000 throughout the visual pass.
- Used Playwright repeatedly to switch to UI Foundations, scroll the Visual Hierarchy group into view, wait for images to load and decode, inspect computed CSS for individual frames, capture full-section screenshots, capture tight crops for affected focus frames, and verify that hover preview cloned the correct composed element.

Work Completed - On-Scrolling Tertiary Focus Replacement and Cream Fade

- Imported
`/Users/prahlin/gh/alla_vostra/mob/taste111_mos9_bright_soft_mockup_tile_blend_both_mockup.png`
into `public/images/alla-vostra/taste111_mos9_bright_soft_mockup_tile_blend_both_mockup.png`, preserving the 853 x 1280 transparent PNG asset.
- Rewired Visual Hierarchy Step 5, the On-Scrolling tertiary focus frame, from the older `alla-vostra-home-mosaic-transparent-after-polygons.png` asset to the imported MOS9 bright soft mockup tile blend image.
- Updated the Step 5 frame aspect ratio from 1440 / 1280 to 853 / 1280 so the browser framed the imported asset at its natural proportions.
- Added a cream background gradient using the established Alla Vostra cream color `#ffcf2`, first using broad center opacity and then iterating the fade stops based on user review.
- Refined the shared Step 5 fade treatment to keep 10 percent cream opacity at the top and bottom, reach full cream opacity by the upper-middle region, remain full through the lower-middle region, and reduce back toward the edge.
- Added a whole-frame opacity mask so the picture and the cream background could fade together at the top and bottom, rather than only fading the background behind the image.

Work Completed - Pre-Scrolling Secondary, Tertiary, and Quaternary Fade Variants

- Applied the same overall fade language to the Pre-Scrolling right-column focus frames while intentionally leaving Step 1 PRIMARY FOCUS unchanged as the full original viewing area.
- Added per-frame logic for Step 1b SECONDARY FOCUS, Step 1c TERTIARY FOCUS, and Step 1d QUATERNARY FOCUS so each could use a different fade profile without destabilizing the rest of the Visual Hierarchy sequence.
- Made secondary focus ramp more aggressively from bottom to top, using a 92 percent lower cutoff so the bottom fade reaches full opacity much faster than the earlier shared 75 percent treatment.
- Made tertiary focus only slightly more aggressive, using an 82 percent lower cutoff so the photo crop retains a gentler fade than secondary but still clears the lower edge more decisively.
- Reworked quaternary focus through several iterations: first a taller three-zone frame, then a half-zone frame, then a softened multi-stop vertical fade, then a radial oval, then a landscape-oblong cream field with explicit side-zone breathing room.
- Changed the quaternary frame from a full-frame vertical mask to a transparent radial cream background so the cream field itself could fade out instead of being clipped by a rectangular mask.
- Preserved the accepted oblong cream look while widening the quaternary frame canvas and scaling the cheeseboard inside it, allowing the cream gradient to reach full transparency before touching the left or right frame edges.

Work Completed - Protected Cheeseboard Composition

- Extended PlaceholderScreen with a protectedImageOverlay option so a clean image layer can be positioned above a faded screenshot frame while the underlying screenshot still receives its cream background and opacity treatment.
- Added flow-protected-image-composition, flow-protected-image-cutout, and flow-protected-image-overlay support in app/globals.css so protected product layers can share the same frame footprint and hover cursor as the regular screenshot frame.
- Positioned the clean cheeseboard product PNG over the baked cheeseboard location in Step 1b and Step 1c using percent-based left, top, width, and 405 / 250 aspect-ratio values derived from the source screenshot geometry.
- Added a matching cutout layer underneath the protected overlay, using the cheeseboard PNG itself as a CSS mask filled with #fffcf2. This punched out the baked cheeseboard from the original secondary/tertiary screenshot area before the clean protected board was drawn above it.
- Fixed the duplicate-board artifact reported by the user after the first overlay attempt, where the new crisp cheeseboard appeared on top of the old faded baked-in cheeseboard.
- Kept the secondary and tertiary photo/header/nav regions subject to their opacity blends while keeping only the cheeseboard product asset crisp and protected.

Work Completed - Screenshot Preview Composition Support

- Added a data-screenshot-preview-composition selector to app/ScreenshotPreviewLayer.tsx so the preview system can prefer a composed frame element before falling back to image-only or group-level preview targets.
- Marked Step 5 and the Pre-Scrolling faded/protected frames as composed screenshot preview targets so hover and tap magnification clone the actual visual composition, including CSS background gradients, masks, protected cutouts, overlay images, and image transforms.
- Verified through Playwright that Step 1b and Step 1c hover previews clone the composition with both the cutout and protected overlay present.
- Verified that Step 1d hover preview preserves the wider oblong cream field, no mask, centered

product image, and current transform scale.

- Retained existing preview behavior for ordinary images and group previews by inserting the composed-target detection ahead of the older preview target selection logic without removing the existing pathways.

Work Completed - Tutorial Assets, Snapshot, and Commit Context

- The August 14 source commit also added multiple Alla Vostra tutorial capture assets under `public/images/alla-vostra/tutorial`, including timestamped large tutorial captures, timestamped small tutorial step captures, canonical `tutorial_screen_large.png` and `tutorial_screen_small.png` files, and `tutorial_screen_small_step_01.png` through `tutorial_screen_small_step_05.png`.
- Added root-level `public/images/tutorial_screen_large.png` and `public/images/tutorial_screen_small.png` alongside the nested Alla Vostra tutorial assets.
- Refreshed `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` during the source commit and again immediately before generating this August 14 PDF. The later refresh records the current source tree, newly cleared `.next` cache directories, latest git status, and current worklog inventory.
- Recommended the user-requested commit message in one-header plus hyphen-line format. The source work was then committed as 374ce86, Refined Alla Vostra visual hierarchy focus blends, with `app/ScreenshotPreviewLayer.tsx`, `app/globals.css`, `app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx`, the snapshot, the imported MOS9 image, and tutorial assets included.
- After that commit, a final local `ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx` delta removed the explicit Step 0 PRIMARY FOCUS mapping from `visualHierarchyStepTitles`, leaving the Tutorial row's Step 0 title behavior to the default step label while the committed focus-blend changes remain otherwise intact.

Validation Summary

- `npm run check` passed repeatedly during the August 14 source pass and during this August 14 PDF-generation pass, confirming TypeScript succeeded with `tsc --noEmit`.
- Playwright confirmed the Alla Vostra route could be opened locally, the UI Foundations tab could be selected, and the Visual Hierarchy group exposed the Pre-Scrolling, On-Scrolling, and During Shopping stacks for measurement and screenshot capture.
- Browser computed-style probes confirmed Step 1 primary focus stayed untreated, Step 1b/1c/1d and Step 5 carried the intended background/mask/composition settings, and later probes confirmed Step 1d no longer used a full-frame mask after the oblong side-zone refinement.
- Tight screenshot crops verified the secondary and tertiary frames no longer showed duplicated cheeseboards after the cutout layer was added underneath the protected overlay.
- Tight screenshot crops verified the quaternary frame evolved from a hard rectangular band into an oblong cream field, then into a wider side-zone composition where the gradient cleared the left and right frame bounds.
- Hover-preview probes verified secondary and tertiary clone the protected composition with overlay/cutout layers and quaternary clone preserves the oblong cream background and image transform.
- Development cache clears and server restarts confirmed stale `.next` output was removed before several browser checks. The server was left live at `http://127.0.0.1:3000` after the final cache clear.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- `app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx`: added fade constants, per-frame Visual Hierarchy treatment logic, imported MOS9 Step 5 source, protected cheeseboard overlay/cutout support, quaternary oblong side-zone sizing, Step 5 ratio correction, image-unoptimized

- routing, composed preview flags, and the later local Step 0 title-map adjustment.
- app/ScreenshotPreviewLayer.tsx: added composed screenshot preview target detection so hover/tap preview can clone complete frame compositions instead of only nested images.
- app/globals.css: added protected-image composition, cutout, and overlay styles for the Visual Hierarchy frame pair system.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt: refreshed to document the current project tree, git state, worklog inventory, added assets, and local cache-clearing artifacts.
- public/images/alla-vostra/taste111_mos9_bright_soft_mockup_tile_blend_both_mockup.png: imported from the Alla Vostra repository and used as the On-Scrolling tertiary focus frame.
- public/images/alla-vostra/tutorial/* and public/images/tutorial_screen_large.png / public/images/tutorial_screen_small.png: added tutorial capture assets that now live in the project image inventory.
- portfolio_worklog_august14.pdf: generated as the new root-level PDF worklog artifact for this August 14 Portfolio session.

Follow-Up Context

- The latest committed source state is 374ce86 on main and origin/main. The only local source delta after that commit at PDF-generation time is the Step 0 title-map removal in ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx plus the refreshed project snapshot and this new PDF artifact.
- The current quaternary focus treatment intentionally preserves the accepted cream gradient look and opacity while widening the frame's horizontal canvas so the gradient fades to transparency before reaching an invisible side wall.
- The secondary and tertiary protected cheeseboard treatment depends on keeping the cutout layer and overlay layer geometrically synchronized. If those source images are replaced later, the percent coordinates should be remeasured rather than reused blindly.
- No production deployment was performed. The work remains local unless the user explicitly requests commit, push, deploy, publish, or Hostinger synchronization.

Output Artifact

- Created portfolio_worklog_august14.pdf at the root of /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio using the same root-level filename pattern as the prior Portfolio PDFs.
- The PDF was generated after reading the complete existing Portfolio worklog set, refreshing the project snapshot, and checking the latest source and validation state.
- The document records the August 14 Alla Vostra Visual Hierarchy blending, protected-cheeseboard, screenshot-preview, asset-import, cache-clearing, and validation work in the established Prahlin Portfolio worklog format.